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E1 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 9: Describing people – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to say five sentences about a person in a picture: who it is, what they look like, what they are wearing and how they feel. This prepares Task 3.

Materials: Handout E1-9A, one per learner. Six printed colour photos of one person each, numbered on the back, with clear clothes in strong colours: a tall man in a blue jacket; a woman in a red dress; a boy in a yellow T-shirt; an older woman in a green coat; a man in a white shirt and black trousers; a girl in a pink hat. Coloured pens or paper in eight colours.

Activity 1: Colours and clothes (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Hold up coloured pens or paper one at a time. Elicit and drill eight colours: *red, blue, green, yellow, black, white, brown, pink*.
2. Say: “Touch something blue.” Learners touch something of that colour in the room or on their clothes. Do all eight, fast.
3. Point to your own clothes and name them. Elicit and board: *shirt, T-shirt, jacket, coat, trousers, jeans, dress, skirt, shoes, hat, scarf*. Drill. Mark *trousers, jeans* and *shoes* as words that are always plural.
4. Say: “Stand up if you are wearing jeans.” Continue with six items and colours.
5. Learners write two true sentences about their own clothes in section A of the handout.

Activity 2: He is wearing… (25 minutes)

1. Hold up a photo. Say: “He is wearing a blue jacket.” Board the pattern in boxes: *He / She / is wearing / a / colour / clothes*.
2. Drill with each of the six photos. Show that *a* disappears with *trousers, jeans* and *shoes*: “He is wearing black trousers.”
3. Put the photos on the board with numbers showing. Say a sentence. Learners call the number.
4. Pairs take turns: one says a sentence, the other points to the photo.
5. Describe a learner in the room without the name: “She is wearing a green scarf.” The class says who. Learners then do this in pairs. Rule: clothes only.

Activity 3: Is and has (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Use two photos. Say: “He is tall. She is short.” Show with your hand. Add *young* and *old*, with *older* as the kinder word for a real person.
2. Point to hair. Say: “She has long hair. He has short hair.” Board two columns: *is* with *tall, short, young, happy, sad*; *has* with *long hair, short hair, a beard, glasses*.
3. Drill by pointing at photos. Learners choose *is* or *has* and finish the sentence.
4. Add two feelings with faces: *happy* and *sad*. Add *tired* with a yawn.
5. Learners circle *is* or *has* in section B of the handout. Check together aloud.

Activity 4: Five sentences (25 minutes)

1. Model the five-finger description with one photo: “This is a man. He is tall. He has short hair. He is wearing a blue jacket. He is happy.”
2. Do a second photo with the class supplying each sentence as you hold up a finger.
3. Give each pair a photo. They write five sentences in section C of the handout.
4. Pairs swap photos with another pair and say five sentences about the new one without writing.
5. Hear four pairs. Praise full sentences with *is, has* and *is wearing*.

Activity 5: Mini exam, Task 3 (25 minutes)

1. Explain: the assessor gives you a picture. You tell your partner and the assessor about it.

2. Groups of three: speaker, partner, counter. The speaker takes a photo and says five sentences. The counter holds up a finger for each one.
3. The partner asks one question: “Is he happy?” or “What colour is her coat?”
4. Rotate until everyone has described two photos.
5. Close: describe one learner’s clothes in three sentences. The class guesses. Then one learner describes you.

Answer key, Lesson 9

- **Section B:** 1 is, 2 has, 3 is, 4 has, 5 is, 6 has.